have. As a nation we have always thrived on competition, and we always will.

Throughout the eight years of my presidency, no alliance we had was stronger than the one between the United States and the United Kingdom. Not only did Margaret Thatcher and I become personal friends and share a similar philosophy about government; the alliance was strengthened by the long special relationship between our countries born of shared democratic values, common Anglo-Saxon roots, a common language, and a friendship deepened and mellowed by fighting two world wars side by side. The depth of this special relationship made it impossible for us to remain neutral during Britain's war with Argentina over the Falkland Islands in 1982, although it was a conflict in which I had to walk a fine line.

Argentine marines wearing civilian clothes landed on South Georgia Island, a British possession in the South Atlantic about 600 miles east of the Falklands, in late March 1982. At about the same time, our intelligence indicated, Argentina was preparing to invade the Falklands, an archipelago of two hundred or so islands located 250 miles off the coast of Argentina. The islands had been under British rule for nearly a century and a half.

After the landing on South Georgia Island, Margaret Thatcher called me and said that Britain would never submit to a takeover of one of its crown colonies. She asked me to telephone Leopoldo Galtieri, president of the military junta that ruled Argentina, to urge him not to proceed with the invasion and to say that Britain would use whatever force was necessary to keep her colony.

I spoke to Galtieri for about forty minutes, but couldn't budge him: He claimed that the Falklands (which he called the Malvinas), by reasons of history, culture, and proximity, rightfully belonged to Argentina, not to a European colonial